

E018

Cloud Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A regional credit union with 40 branches moves its email to a SaaS suite from a large provider. The provider's marketing highlights its 24/7 security operations center. A former employee's account was never disabled and was used to read member messages. Under the shared responsibility model, who was responsible for disabling that account?

- A. The provider's security operations center, because it monitors the service around the clock.
- B. The provider, because SaaS makes the provider responsible for all security.
- C. The credit union, because customers always manage their own user identities and access.
- D. Shared equally, because SaaS is a shared model.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task does a customer still perform under IaaS that it would NOT perform under SaaS?

- A. Patching the guest operating system.
- B. Classifying the data it stores.
- C. Replacing failed physical disks.
- D. Deciding which employees get access.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A hospital network must keep patient records in its own audited data center for the next four years under a state agreement, but wants to use public cloud analytics on de-identified data. Its CIO recently spoke at a national conference, and its IT staff grew by 15% last year. Which deployment model fits best?

- A. Public cloud only, because it is the modern standard.
- B. Private cloud only.
- C. Hybrid cloud.
- D. Multi-cloud, because the staff has grown enough to run several providers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A distributor is comparing options for its order system. Buying servers costs \$300,000 upfront with a five-year life plus \$40,000 a year in maintenance. A cloud option costs \$7,500 a month. The server vendor has offered free installation and a branded rack. Over a full year, which option is cheaper and by how much?

- A. Cloud, by \$10,000 a year.
- B. On-premises, by \$50,000 a year.
- C. On-premises, by \$10,000 a year.
- D. Cloud, by \$210,000 a year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Servers cost \$240,000 and last four years. The cloud alternative costs \$6,000 a month. At what annual on-premises maintenance cost would the two options cost the same per year?

- A. \$132,000
- B. \$1,000
- C. \$72,000
- D. \$12,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An online ticket seller's traffic is flat most of the year but jumps tenfold for two weeks when festival tickets go on sale. The team moved its on-premises servers to cloud VMs of the same size and left them running all year. The company's logo was redesigned last spring. Cloud bills are higher than expected. What is the best explanation?

- A. They should buy more reserved capacity for the peak.
- B. They pay for peak capacity every day instead of scaling up only for the two-week spike.
- C. The move was a rehost, which is a migration strategy.
- D. Cloud is always more expensive than on-premises hosting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A law firm replaces its self-hosted document system, which runs on an aging server in a closet, with a subscription SaaS product and moves the files into it. The partners voted 7-2 to approve the budget. Which migration strategy is this?

- A. Retire.
- B. Repurchase.
- C. Rehost.
- D. Refactor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team moves its web application to the cloud and, during the move, swaps its self-managed database for the provider's managed database service without changing application code. Which strategy did it use?

- A. Replatform.
- B. Rehost.
- C. Retain.
- D. Refactor.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A European retailer that sells to customers in six countries is drafting its cloud policy. Its chosen provider offers regions worldwide, and the default region for new accounts is in the United States. The marketing team wants to launch a loyalty app in three weeks. What should the policy require for customer personal data?

- A. Encrypt the data, which removes any residency requirement.
- B. Approved regions and transfer safeguards that satisfy applicable data-protection law, set before deployment.
- C. Let the marketing team choose a region so the launch date is met.
- D. Use the provider's default region, since major providers are compliant everywhere.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A media company built its platform on one provider's proprietary serverless and database services. Egress fees are high, and the contract has no data-export terms. The company won an industry award last year. Leadership asks how to reduce lock-in risk. What is the best first step?

- A. Negotiate lower compute prices.
- B. Move everything back on-premises immediately.
- C. Add a second cloud provider, which eliminates lock-in.
- D. Build an exit plan: portable data formats, negotiated export terms, and a tested data export.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A payroll SaaS vendor headquartered in Denver with 2,000 business customers offers a 99.9% monthly uptime SLA at \$18 per user per month. For a 30-day month, how much downtime does the SLA allow?

- A. About 7.2 hours.
- B. About 4.3 minutes.
- C. About 8.8 hours.
- D. About 43 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A contract allows no more than about 4.3 minutes of downtime in a 30-day month. What availability percentage does that equal?

- A. 99.999%
- B. 100%, because any downtime breaks a contract.
- C. 99.99%
- D. 99.9%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A regional credit union ~~with 40 branches~~ moves its email to a SaaS suite from a large provider. ~~The provider's marketing highlights its 24/7 security operations center.~~ A former employee's account was never disabled and was used to read member messages. Under the shared responsibility model, who was responsible for disabling that account?

Target word: who owns account lifecycle in SaaS **Decides:** Identity and access management stays with the customer in every service model.

A	Camouflage	Answers the SOC detail; monitoring the platform is not managing the customer's users.
B	Absolute language	SaaS shifts infrastructure and application security, not the customer's access decisions.
C	Correct	Even in SaaS, the customer controls who has accounts and what they can see.
D	Adjacent category	"Shared" means split duties, not joint ownership of each duty.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which task does a customer still perform under IaaS that it would NOT perform under SaaS?

Target word: reverse: find the duty that moves to the provider going from IaaS to SaaS **Decides:** In IaaS the customer manages the operating system and above.

A	Correct	IaaS customers patch the OS; in SaaS the provider does.
B	Confusion set	Data ownership and classification remain with the customer in every model.
C	Adjacent category	Hardware is the provider's job in IaaS too.
D	Inverted operation	That duty stays with the customer in both models.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A hospital network must keep patient records in its own audited data center for the next four years under a state agreement, but wants to use public cloud analytics on de-identified data. ~~Its CIO recently spoke at a national conference, and its IT staff grew by 15% last year.~~ Which deployment model fits best?

Target word: deployment model that fits both constraints **Decides:** Some data must stay on-premises while other workloads use public cloud.

A	Absolute language	Ignores the requirement to keep records in its own data center.
B	Dropped element	Meets the records rule but drops the public analytics goal.
C	Correct	Combines the required private environment with public cloud analytics.
D	Camouflage	Staff growth does not decide; multi-cloud means several public providers, not an on-premises mix.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A distributor is comparing options for its order system. Buying servers costs \$300,000 upfront with a five-year life plus \$40,000 a year in maintenance. A cloud option costs \$7,500 a month. ~~The server vendor has offered free installation and a branded rack.~~ Over a full year, which option is cheaper and by how much?

Target word: annual cost comparison **Decides:** On-premises annual cost = $\$300,000 / 5 + \$40,000 = \$100,000$; cloud = $\$7,500 \times 12 = \$90,000$.

A	Correct	\$100,000 on-premises vs. \$90,000 cloud.
B	Dropped element	Compares only the \$40,000 maintenance to cloud; leaves out the \$60,000 a year of hardware cost.
C	Inverted operation	Right gap, wrong direction.
D	Wrong stem number	Sets the full upfront price against one year of cloud fees.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Servers cost \$240,000 and last four years. The cloud alternative costs \$6,000 a month. At what annual on-premises maintenance cost would the two options cost the same per year?

Target word: solve for maintenance at break-even **Decides:** Cloud \$72,000 a year – hardware \$60,000 a year = \$12,000.

A	Inverted operation	Adds the two annual figures instead of taking the difference.
B	Dropped element	The monthly gap; the question asks per year.
C	Wrong stem number	The annual cloud cost, not the maintenance gap.
D	Correct	$\$6,000 \times 12 = \$72,000$; $\$240,000 / 4 = \$60,000$; $\$72,000 - \$60,000 = \$12,000$.

6. Answer B Concept 4

An online ticket seller's traffic is flat most of the year but jumps tenfold for two weeks when festival tickets go on sale. The team moved its on-premises servers to cloud VMs of the same size and left them running all year. ~~The company's logo was redesigned last spring.~~ Cloud bills are higher than expected. What is the best explanation?

Target word: why the cloud bill did not fall **Decides:** Peak-sized capacity runs all year instead of scaling with demand.

A	Inverted operation	Locking in peak capacity all year makes the waste worse.
B	Correct	Elasticity saves money only if capacity follows demand.
C	Confusion set	True but does not explain the cost; the issue is sizing, not the migration label.
D	Absolute language	Cost depends on how capacity is managed, not a universal rule.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A law firm replaces its self-hosted document system, which runs on an aging server in a closet, with a subscription SaaS product and moves the files into it. ~~The partners voted 7-2 to approve the budget.~~ Which migration strategy is this?

Target word: name the strategy **Decides:** Switching to a different commercial SaaS product.

A	Dropped element	The old system goes away, but the capability is replaced, not removed.
B	Correct	Replacing the application with a SaaS product is repurchase ("drop and shop").
C	Confusion set	Rehost moves the same application as-is to new infrastructure.
D	Adjacent category	Refactor rewrites the firm's own application for the cloud.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A team moves its web application to the cloud and, during the move, swaps its self-managed database for the provider's managed database service without changing application code. Which strategy did it use?

Target word: strategy from a described change **Decides:** Small optimization with no re-architecture.

A	Correct	A targeted optimization (managed database) without rewriting the app.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the database change; rehost means no changes.
C	Inverted operation	Retain keeps the workload where it is.
D	Adjacent category	Refactor changes the application's architecture and code.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A European retailer that sells to customers in six countries is drafting its cloud policy. Its chosen provider offers regions worldwide, and the default region for new accounts is in the United States. ~~The marketing team wants to launch a loyalty app in three weeks.~~ What should the policy require for customer personal data?

Target word: policy control for regulated data location **Decides:** Personal data location must be set by policy to meet applicable law, not left to the default.

A	Adjacent category	Encryption protects data but does not by itself satisfy location or transfer rules.
B	Correct	Residency is a policy decision the customer must make and enforce.
C	Camouflage	The deadline does not decide; compliance does.
D	Absolute language	Provider certifications do not make every data location lawful for the customer.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A media company built its platform on one provider's proprietary serverless and database services. Egress fees are high, and the contract has no data-export terms. ~~The company won an industry award last year.~~ Leadership asks how to reduce lock-in risk. What is the best first step?

Target word: reduce lock-in **Decides:** An exit strategy with portable data and contract terms addresses the cause.

A	Adjacent category	Addresses cost, not the ability to leave.
B	Inverted operation	Trades one dependency for a costly reversal without a plan.
C	Absolute language	Multi-cloud can add complexity; proprietary dependencies on the first provider remain.
D	Correct	Directly lowers switching cost and risk.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A payroll SaaS vendor ~~headquartered in Denver with 2,000 business customers~~ offers a 99.9% monthly uptime SLA ~~at \$18 per user per month~~. For a 30-day month, how much downtime does the SLA allow?

Target word: allowed monthly downtime **Decides:** 43,200 minutes × 0.001.

A	Wrong stem number	That is 99%, dropping a nine from the stem.
B	Confusion set	That is 99.99%, one more nine.
C	Adjacent category	That is 99.9% over a year, not a month.
D	Correct	$30 \times 24 \times 60 = 43,200$ minutes × 0.1% = 43.2 minutes.

12. Answer C Concept 8 · transfer

A contract allows no more than about 4.3 minutes of downtime in a 30-day month. What availability percentage does that equal?

Target word: solve for availability **Decides:** $4.32 / 43,200 = 0.01\%$ downtime.

A	Inverted operation	Allows about 26 seconds a month.
B	Absolute language	SLAs define an allowed amount of downtime.
C	Correct	$1 - 0.0001 = 99.99\%$.
D	Confusion set	Allows about 43 minutes a month.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Service models and shared responsibility	The more the provider manages (IaaS → PaaS → SaaS), the less the customer manages — but the customer always owns its data, identities, and access decisions.	Believing that moving to SaaS hands all security and compliance to the provider.	“Who is responsible for...” plus a named service model.
2	Deployment models fit to need	Public, private, hybrid, and multi-cloud are chosen by business constraints — regulation, latency, existing investment, and risk — not by which is newest.	Treating “all public cloud” as the default best answer.	A constraint such as a regulator, a legacy system, or a data-center lease in the stem.
3	CapEx vs. OpEx and total cost of ownership	Compare total cost over the same period: upfront hardware spread over its life plus running costs vs. recurring cloud fees.	Comparing a one-time purchase price to a single month or year of cloud fees.	An upfront amount, a useful life, and a monthly subscription in one stem.
4	Elasticity and right-sizing	Cloud saves money when capacity follows demand; paying for peak capacity all the time wastes the elasticity advantage.	Assuming a lift-and-shift of peak-sized servers will automatically cut costs.	Uneven or seasonal demand.
5	Migration strategies (the Rs)	Rehost moves as-is; replatform makes small optimizations; refactor re-architects; repurchase switches to SaaS; retire removes; retain keeps on-premises.	Calling any move to a SaaS product a “rehost.”	A description of how much the application changes during the move.
6	Cloud policy: data residency and compliance	Policy must specify where regulated data may be stored and processed and who approves new services; the provider’s default region does not satisfy a legal requirement.	Assuming a major provider is automatically compliant for every law.	A regulation or country named next to a storage or region decision.
7	Vendor lock-in and exit planning	Lock-in risk grows with proprietary services and data egress costs; an exit strategy (portable formats, contract terms, tested export) reduces it.	Believing multi-cloud alone eliminates lock-in.	“What if we need to leave the provider?”
8	SLA availability math	Allowed downtime = period length × (1 – availability); each added nine cuts downtime by a factor of ten.	Confusing 99.9% with 99.99%, or monthly with yearly downtime.	A percentage with nines and a time period.

Course scope (public description): Cloud Strategy will explore cloud solutions for an organization. The student will research available cloud technologies and determine which ones align most effectively with business needs. The learner will propose specific policies for an organization in relationship to its use of cloud technology. Finally, the student will recommend a broader cloud strategy for a specific organization. There are no prerequisites for this course.